

1964–1969

MINI MAGIC

The miniskirt spearheaded a fashion revolution, and the minidress came along hot on its heels. This one-piece was easy and versatile for young women to wear, with the basic A-line design flattering all shapes and sizes. Its very simplicity meant it could be dressed up or down. From minimal cuts and block colours to powerful patterns and pop art prints, the dress could be as everyday or daring as the wearer wanted. Real trendsetters experimented with bold fabrics, such as metallic PVC and shiny rayon. The straight lines of the minidress silhouette left room for accessories to share the limelight. Matching handbags and shoes became a popular way to enhance and accentuate outfits. With the invention of tights, women were able to wear shorter hemlines while maintaining their modesty.



Pretty in pink Similar to a minidress but sleeveless and slightly longer, the shift dress – an unwaisted design that grew out of Balenciaga's sack style of the 1950s – was also favoured during the 1960s. This classic shift dress is made from a vibrantly dyed linen, with a printed, backed collar.

British belter This outfit by Mary Quant demonstrates her creativity as a designer. Half-dress, half-skirt, the deep cutaway sides and large buckle fastening at the halter neck are both innovative and playful.



All in white This striking minidress from the 1960s boasts a crisp cut and a neat finish. The collar and hem detail breaks up the block white that was popular at the time. Long sleeves and a loose-fitting waistline present a casual, youthful look.

Polka-dot dress Worn with shiny white go-go boots, sleeveless minidresses were a hit on the dancefloor, as they gave women freedom to move. The basic shape of this minidress lets the polka-dot pattern take centre stage.

POP ART

During the 1950s a new artistic movement called Pop Art took off in Britain and the US. Using images from advertising and popular culture, artists and designers made statements on the fleeting and throwaway nature of post-war society. American artist Andy Warhol led the Pop Art revolution, creating designs inspired by iconic products and famous faces.

This Souper Dress pays homage to Warhol's Campbell's Soup prints, with the distinctive label multiplied into a repeating screenprint design. The simple shape of the minidress was an ideal blank canvas to showcase Warhol's prints. And fashion provided the perfect medium for discussing themes of capitalism and commerce, art and the everyday.



The Souper Dress